What I have now

WORKBOOK PAGE 1 · CHAPTER 1, STEP 1

Follow Chapter 1, Step 1. On plain paper, copy these headings. Add lines as needed.

Today's date: My own / our household:

Use the same person or household on all four pages.

Money I have now

Open your accounts and count your cash. Copy balances you can check. If you can't find an amount, write “not sure yet.”

Where the money is	Balance shown / label	Available amount, if different	Date checked / things to note
Everyday account	$	$	
Savings account	$	$	
Money held in an app	$	$	
Cash I counted	$	-	
Other account	$	$	

Use one balance per account: current if shown, or the copied balance with its label. Don't add the available column as extra money. Count transfers once. Leave out credit limits. Put below-zero balances on page 3 as money owed.

Money I have now: $

Add confirmed positive balances and cash. Mark the total **partial** if anything is missing.

Accounts or amounts still to check:

Holds, pending items, or money set aside for bills:

This total is not all free to spend. Keep the notes beside it.

Other things I own

Keep investments, retirement accounts, property, and other assets separate. Label estimates. Don't repeat a balance you've counted above.

What I own	Value shown or estimate	Date / what to check
	$	
	$	
	$	

NEXT · Workbook page 2: What comes in

What comes in

WORKBOOK PAGE 2 · CHAPTER 1, STEP 2

Follow Chapter 1, Step 2. On plain paper, copy these headings. Add lines as needed.

Month and year:

Currency used for my totals:

Income and support

Groups: **Employer · Own work · Assets · Support / retirement.** If you're not sure where a payment fits, mark its group “not sure yet.”

For employer pay, use what reaches you after payroll deductions. For own work or rent, subtract known costs. Note costs or tax still to cover. Mark unknown amounts “not sure yet.” **The last two columns are optional for now.**

Source	Group	Received this month	Next payment / does it vary? (if known)	Costs or tax still to cover (if known)
		$		
		$		
		$		
		$		

Income and support received during _____: $

Sources or amounts still to check / is this total partial?

Costs or tax still to cover:

Other cash received

Keep savings withdrawals, sales, one-time gifts, and borrowing here. Count transfers once. Don't include these amounts again in the income total above.

Where it came from	Amount received	One-time or repeat?	Must I pay it back?
	$		
	$		
	$		

Bills paid for me or other help that isn't cash:

A month's income and today's bank balance are different. Some income may already be in the balance on page 1. Keep the totals separate.

NEXT · Workbook page 3: What I owe

What I owe

WORKBOOK PAGE 3 · CHAPTER 1, STEP 3

Follow Chapter 1, Step 3. On plain paper, copy these headings. Add lines as needed.

Today's date:

Money I owe

Check loans, cards, bills, taxes, and money borrowed from people. Copy the amount still owed. Don't use a monthly payment as the whole debt. Count each amount once.

Payment dates, interest, fees, and terms are optional for now. Write them down if you know them. If you don't, leave the box blank or write “not sure yet.” We'll go through the details later in the book.

Who I owe / what for	Amount still owed / date checked	Next payment and date (if known)	Interest, fees, or terms (if known)
	$		
	$		
	$		
	$		
	$		

If a balance is missing, write “not sure yet.” Keep the person or company on the list.

Money I owe: $

Add confirmed balances only. Mark this total **partial** if a balance is missing. An unknown amount isn't zero.

Unknown or disputed amounts to check:

Keep business debts on a separate list. Note any you may be responsible for yourself. Don't count the same debt twice.

Business debts / responsibility to check:

If a payment needs attention now, don't wait to finish another chapter to deal with it.

NEXT · Workbook page 4: My money today

My money today

WORKBOOK PAGE 4 · CHAPTER 1, STEP 4

Use the example in Chapter 1, Step 4. Copy your totals from pages 1-3, or use plain paper.

Today's date:

My own / our household:

What I have

Money I have now: $

Accounts still to check / is this total partial?

Holds, pending items, or money already set aside:

Other things I own, with values or estimates kept separate:

What comes in

Income and support received during _____: $

My current sources of income or support:

Amounts still to check / is this total partial?

Costs or tax still to cover:

What I owe

Money I owe: $

Unknown or disputed amounts to check / is this total partial?

The next bill or payment I need to look at (if known):

My starting path

Use the four paths in Chapter 1.

My starting path - I-D, I-ND, N-D, or N-ND:

One number or term I still need to check:

Put the pen down and look at the page. Read each total and the gaps you've marked. This is what you know today. You can keep going with a few boxes left blank.

Keep the totals separate. Cash, a month's income, and debt each tell you something different. Don't add them together. Keep this sheet and update it when things change.

NEXT · Return to “Where to go next” in Chapter 1 for your next chapter.